A Certain Kind of Healing

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/33000703.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Porn with some plot, Unhealthy Coping Mechanisms, Mental Illness, Panic Attacks, Adora Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Adora Has Issues (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, sex as a coping mechanism, Shower Sex, Mild Angst with a happy ending, Self-Harm, Accidental Self-Harm, Adora (She-ra) is mentally ill, Oral Sex, Praise Kink, Face Sitting, Dorks in Love, the third chapter is unreasonably fluffy please enjoy

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A Certain Kind of Healing

by Asphyxia

Summary

*"Catra, **please**…" Adora's voice was heavy, strained, and Catra bit down only a shade firmer on the shell of her ear, tasting just the faintest hint of blood, and felt Adora shudder all the way from her shoulders to her molten core.*

"Please what?" she whispered into the princess' ear, her fingers inside her stilling just long enough to force Adora to focus and give her an answer.

"Tell me I'm good…"

Adora has panic attacks, Catra has feelings, and between them they have an arrangement: they are only enemies outside the bedroom.

Notes

Long time no see! I've been working on my first full-length SPOP fanfic lately (it's already 30,000 words!) and I don't want to start uploading it until I'm done writing it! So for now

I'm going to upload some of the shorter stuff I've written in the past and that includes this fic! I have a lot of fics I've written and wasn't sure if they were "good" enough to post but I've decided to stop being self-conscious and just post them. Hopefully this fic is enjoyable even though it's less polished and shorter than my usual stuff.

See the end of the work for more notes

Chapter 1

"Catra, *please*…" Adora's voice was heavy, strained, and Catra bit down only a shade firmer on the shell of her ear, tasting just the faintest hint of blood, and felt Adora shudder all the way from her shoulders to her molten core.

"Please what?" she whispered into the princess' ear, her fingers inside her stilling just long enough to force Adora to focus and give her an answer.

"Tell me I'm good…"

Catra's heart softened and as she pushed her face into Adora's cheek, nuzzling her gently, her fingers began to move again. "You're good, Adora," she promised, her own voice trembling, and Adora moaned a little louder than she probably should have, but Catra wasn't about to chastise her for the amount of noise she was making when she was like *this*. "You're so good. I promise."

Every once in a while, Adora would come to her like this, broken and vulnerable and needing Catra's touch, needing to be reminded that she was good. It was all she had ever craved her entire life, to be *good*, and Catra's words, against all logic, were what seemed to make her believe it, if even for just a short while. These days Catra was filled with bitterness toward Adora that bubbled over into a rage that couldn't be quelled, not by anything. The resentment she felt toward the girl in her arms on a normal day was almost too much to bear and the pain of it threatened to tear her apart. But on days like this, when Adora slipped into the Fright Zone so devoid of the normal infuriating self-righteousness and gusto that characterized her behavior, fractured and unsure and *needing* her, all of that fell away. None of the distance between them existed when they were like this. Against all odds, Adora needed *her*. Catra was the only thing that could keep her held together when she was falling apart. Adora, who Catra had once believed was so irritatingly *perfect*, was flawed in her own strange, almost terrifying way.

When Catra had first realized there was something…*wrong* with Adora, it had not been long after they first became senior cadets. One particular night Adora disappeared sometime after dinner and by the time lights out rolled around she was still missing. After some snooping around and following her scent, Catra found Adora in the showers, tucked into a stall in the very back, and she had to crawl under the door to get in because Adora wasn't responsive enough to unlock it. She was pressed against the wall, only half under the falling water, her arms wrapped protectively around herself and her fingernails digging so hard into her own skin that there was blood mixing with the trails of water running down her body.

The way she was pressed hard against the shower wall breathing in short gasps and the thundering of her heart that was audible to Catra's sensitive ears the moment she got a few inches away was unlike anything she'd ever experienced from Adora, Adora who was normally so steadfast and sturdy and borderline *stoic* when it came to showing she was upset over things. It was almost terrifying. Catra, who had never experienced this sort of reaction from her friend, had been completely unsure of what to do. Adora's heavy breaths echoed off the walls of the shower and Catra's clothes were completely soaked as she moved in to get close to her, struggling to get through to her. The only thing that would come out of Adora's mouth was a series of manic, disjointed whispers.

"I'm not good," she kept saying over and over, digging her nails into herself, and Catra was…afraid. She was afraid of this fragile version of Adora who looked at her with glassy eyes that trembled with an uncertainty that was so uncharacteristic of her that Catra actually tried slapping her to snap her out of it, but she barely even reacted. Adora, Catra knew how to deal with. But not…like this. And so she pressed her body to hers, wet spandex flush against bare wet skin, trying to anchor her, and Adora just squirmed against her and when her thigh between Adora's legs made her whimper Catra touched her in a blind panic, her hands firmly caressing every bit of skin she could reach until Adora's breathing was ragged but steady. When her fingers wandered

between Adora's legs, Adora let her touch her there, clumsy but mirroring the way she touched herself.

"You're good," she whispered into the wet hair plastered to Adora's skin in front of her ear, feeling her shiver. "You're so good, Adora. You're so good. You're perfect." She told her over and over as she traced her fingers in small circles over Adora's clit, Adora's arms wrapped tightly around her neck, Adora biting down on Catra's shoulder to hold back the cries that broke up through her throat while she shattered for Catra. She broke apart into little fragments like the sparkling droplets of water that cascaded around them, her hips fluttering against Catra's hand as she begged her raggedly not to stop, her words barely more than incoherent sobs. Catra held her tight with her free arm, her fingertips clumsily swirling over Adora's clit that twitched under her touch, her fingers cramped from how tightly Adora's thighs were clamped around her.

Catra pressed her own thighs together, clenching and unclenching desperately and when Adora shuddered and cried her name it pushed her over the edge. She came as Adora did, their bodies trembling and the sweat that broke out over them washed away by the stream of water, and she kissed Adora bruisingly as they shuddered against each other, each coming down from their peak with soft gasps for air the sounds of which were swallowed by the thundering of the water.

When Adora's breathing began to slow she just slumped against Catra, and time slipped away. She could have held her for minutes or hours, but Catra was completely content to just let her cling to her. When they finally got to bed, Adora still looked a little haggard, but she no longer looked lost and vulnerable and she wasn't shaking anymore. By the next morning she was completely normal, and her uniform hid the cuts from her own fingernails, but she stayed a little closer to Catra than normal.

It continued on like that. Sometimes Catra would seek out Adora when she was missing and find her hunched in a corner or locked in a shower stall, her arms wrapped around herself,

hyperventilating and trembling and babbling nonsense. Catra would promise her again and again that she was good and she would touch her, make her come until she was herself again. That first night in the showers wasn't long after Adora's eighteenth birthday and now here she was, still trembling under Catra's touch, halfway past her twentieth. Catra hadn't expected this to still happen after Adora defected, and she *certainly* hadn't expected it to continue after she opened the portal. But here Adora was, completely naked and straddling her lap on the stiff bed in Catra's private Force Captain quarters as Catra curled her fingers deep inside her, pushing her patiently toward her peak.

"You're so good," Catra whispered again in her ear, nuzzling against her cheek, scent marking her. Anyone who cared to know would be able to tell that Adora belonged to her. Adora moaned again, her arms around Catra tightening, and Catra braced her free hand on her lower back for more support.

"Catra…" she whispered, her tone heavy with need, and Catra moved her hand, shifting her thumb to cover Adora's clit. As she began to rub it firmly along with each thrust of her fingers, Adora's hips stuttered and she released her grip on Catra to lean back on her hands to support herself better. Catra watched her raptly, the way her flushed cheeks gleamed with sweat under the greenish light of the bedroom, the way her lips were parted slightly, her eyes squeezed shut. The look on her face was one of absolute bliss and Catra relished it. In the bedroom, the resentment and bitterness and need to see Adora suffer disappeared, and she wanted nothing more than to see her enjoy herself. To see her fears and doubt fall away and leave nothing but the pleasure only Catra could make her feel. Adora was strong. She was so strong, so much stronger than Catra could ever hope to be. Adora never needed *anything*. So to be able to give her the one thing she'd ever sought out from anyone, as far as Catra knew, was the only kind of high Catra could ever need.

"You're doing great," Catra promised her and Adora keened. Her hips were rolling against Catra's hand, fucking her fingers, and Catra could feel her own arousal searing to a boiling point. Adora

was so wet that she was dripping down Catra's hand and with Adora in her lap she couldn't do anything about how desperately it was turning her on, but she didn't care. She also didn't care how much her wrist was cramping up.

Catra's two fingers pushed Adora onward and while she thrust desperately against her hand her walls began to flutter around her and Catra knew she was close. She moved in to give her a messy kiss, dragging her claws down her back as she did in the way she knew Adora liked, and that did it. She clenched around her fingers, strangled moans and whimpers muffled by Catra's lips as she rocked desperately against her. Catra worked her through her orgasm and curled her fingers slower to bring her through her aftershocks. When Adora slumped against her, wrapping her arms around Catra tight, she reluctantly withdrew her fingers, giving her clit one last encouraging rub before she moved her hand up to her mouth. Adora moaned softly while she watched Catra lick her fingers clean.

"Thank you," Adora whispered, resting her head on her shoulder, and Catra's traitorous heart swelled with love that she struggled to push back down. It responded by thudding even harder. When she'd first crept into her room tonight, Adora had been tense and silent and barely able to articulate her needs, and Catra felt a measure of pride in being able to help her…and pride in Adora for actually coming to her. She'd never been able to ask for what she wanted, not ever. But with Catra, she wanted this—*needed* this—so badly that she would actually take the initiative to come to her first. Adora, who was so infuriatingly independent, sought her out on her own initiative on nights like this when she would normally deal with anything she was struggling with on her own.

It was easy to think, even with how Adora had left her behind to join those stupid princesses, that she didn't need anyone but Catra.

"Catra?" Adora asked softly, her breathing still shallow and labored but steady enough to speak now, and Catra drew back enough to indulge her, tucking a lock of Adora's loose hair behind her ear.

“What? Speak up, Princess.” Her words were careless but her tone still fairly soft; Adora was still coming down from the crest of her earlier panic. She didn’t want to send her spiraling again. She looked at her with an infinite softness in this moment despite the way they normally went at each other in battle with everything they had and Adora’s expression softened too, though the little line of worry beside her eyebrow remained.

“Do you want me to touch you?” she asked, her tone breathless, and Catra stiffened.

Adora had asked her this before, always with the same amount of earnest and reverence that she was looking at her with now, and every time Catra’s chest filled with the turbulent storms of conflict as she looked into those wet bluebell eyes and then away from Adora completely.

“Naw, I’m good,” she told her quickly, shifting a bit, and Adora took the hint and slid from her lap. It was then that Catra realized that some of Adora’s wetness had left a spot on her leggings. Normally she would tease her for it, but right now she felt too torn up to.

Of course Catra wanted Adora to touch her. More than anything, she craved the other woman’s touch in the most desperate way imaginable. She’d spent innumerable nights awake in bed chasing her own orgasm as she thought of all the ways Adora could push her over the edge. It was what she wanted most, in her most secret heart that she kept locked away where no one would ever see. She wanted it so much that it ached, it burned and seared in her chest in a way that was almost physically painful. And that was exactly why she couldn’t have it. If she gave in and let herself have what she’d always wanted more than anything, there would be nothing left to keep her from losing herself completely. To experience the greatest high she could ever know when she and Adora were separated by the most horrible divide imaginable would utterly destroy her.

“I’m sorry,” Adora’s apologetic tone and the frown that came over her face were immediate. “I didn’t mean to make you uncomfortable. You seemed like you needed it so I—”

“You didn’t. Don’t be sorry,” Catra told her with a wave of her hand, watching Adora as she got up from the bed and dressed in silence, pulling on the same uniform she’d dressed in when they would dress together in the mornings. As she expertly pulled her hair back up into its usual ponytail, their eyes met and Catra realized that Adora looked as torn up as she did. The eye contact only remained for a moment, and then Adora turned away and started pulling the Horde soldier armor she’d been stashing somewhere on the outskirts of the Fright Zone over her usual clothes.

“Catra…” Adora began, but the words got lost somewhere. For a long moment neither of them spoke, and Adora closed the gap between them, the helmet of the uniform under one arm as she leaned in to give Catra a kiss. Her lips were gentle and yielding, full of questions, but Catra didn’t have the answers and she only allowed herself to kiss Adora back for a moment before she pushed her gently away.

“Thank you for tonight,” Adora told her earnestly, and Catra looked away.

“Don’t mention it. You’d better go. You’ve already been here too long. Someone might catch us.”

“Right.” Adora pulled her helmet on, and Catra could still see those honest eyes through the sickly green lens of the visor. “I’ll see you soon?”

“On the battlefield, probably,” Catra told her dryly, and Adora’s hands clenched into fists at her sides. “Good luck getting me on the business end of that sword, Princess.”

“Goodnight, Catra.” Adora didn’t seem like she wanted to get into that right now, and so Catra let her go. When she’d waited long

enough to know that Adora had likely gotten out of the Fright Zone and she didn't hear any alarms to indicate she'd gotten herself caught, Catra undressed and crawled under the covers.

In the stark loneliness of the Fright Zone, in a bed that still smelled like Adora and crushed under the oppressive weight of the scent of the princess' sex, Catra touched herself until she cried Adora's name softly, barely above a whisper.

Still surrounded by the scent of Adora, Catra drifted off to an easier sleep than she'd had in weeks.

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

> This chapter is a little longer than the last! It might not line up exactly with canon timelines or anything but that's not the point, is it? You're all here for the spicy stuff so I figure that's what matters lol. I hope you enjoy! Chapter 3 will be up in the next few weeks. Thanks for reading so far!

Normally when Adora was coming to see her, Catra would have some sort of warning. She would smell her, or hear the heavy footfalls of soldier boots clattering down the hall outside her quarters, so when she was awoken from a particularly heavy sleep by the sound of Adora saying her name instead, to say she was shocked was an understatement. For a moment her body flew into fight or flight mode before the adrenaline lulled to a dull panicked ebb and she sat up, ready to admonish Adora for scaring her. At first she didn't even see her; she'd expected the taller woman to be looming over her bed, but instead she was on the floor.

"What are you doing down there?" Catra asked the girl who sat on her knees near the bed, and it struck her immediately that Adora was wearing her normal clothes and not the armor that would conceal her identity if anyone saw her. The fact that she'd managed to get all the way to the inner complex at all was a sheer miracle. "Adora?"

It seemed to take the blonde a great deal of effort to look up at her, and the panic and fear in her eyes twisted something in Catra's chest. The way Adora's body was trembling was nothing new but the raw and pathetic whimpers that were leaving her throat were. She'd never seen her quite like this. Her fingertips were digging into the tops of her own thighs and her shoulders were heaving with what looked like sobs, but her eyes were eerily dry. Catra climbed slowly out of bed, approaching Adora and dropping down to her level. The anger that she'd initially felt when she saw her had dissipated as soon as it came and as she braced

her hands on Adora's shoulders, trying to force her to look at her, a string of words escaped the blonde's lips, coherent despite how much her voice was shaking.

"The First Ones…were using me. Just like Shadow Weaver was using me…everyone just…uses me. Everything I do is someone else's decision. I don't get to choose I…never get to choose. I'll never get to choose."

Catra listened carefully, not really sure what she was talking about and not sure she had the patience to find out. Adora didn't usually even attempt to explain what was going on with her when she got like this as Catra didn't ask. Tonight was definitely different. Normally she knew exactly how to deal with this side of Adora, but right now she felt different. Uniquely desperate. Catra pulled her in for a bruising kiss and felt Adora's shaky hands press into her lower back, pulling her closer, a desperate sound coming from deep in her throat. She only got as far as nibbling on Adora's lower lip before she pulled away enough to speak.

"So choose right now, then," she told her in a voice that rumbled with a deep purr, the possessiveness dripping from her tone obvious even to her own ears. "What do you choose right now, Adora? I'll never do anything you don't want me to do."

"Catra…I…" she trailed off and Catra kissed her roughly again, giving her ponytail a tug that dragged a moan from her throat. The sound set her on fire, heat traveling straight between her legs and making her heart pound.

"Do we just kiss for a while and I send you back to your stupid princess friends, or do I touch you? Choose."

Adora just looked at her blankly. Trying to coax it out of her, Catra moved in for a kiss, a little more insistent this time, and Adora melted into it, her fingertips digging into Catra's back, and she gave her lower lip a warning nip, one fang pressing too hard against the sensitive skin there but not breaking it.

“It’s your choice,” she reminded her, moving to nibble her earlobe, and Adora moaned softly, shifting closer, her chest bumping into Catra’s. “So choose.”

“Touch me,” the princess answered breathlessly, and with a possessive growl Catra moved to latch her mouth onto her neck, almost immediately falling into the motions of sucking at her pulse point. Adora whimpered deliciously, her hips grinding forward even as she sat on the floor on her knees and Catra felt a surge of protectiveness rush through her, the absolute high of being what Adora needed washing away every trace of her bitterness and leaving her warm and possessive instead, an almost feral intensity in her movements as she sunk her teeth into Adora’s flesh just enough to barely prick the skin. She licked the tiny droplets of blood that formed there away before she shifted to lift Adora onto the bed, only straining a little in the process.

“You’ve gotten stronger,” Adora remarked, her tone still shaky, but she did seem to be calming down a little already.

“Fighting She-ra keeps me in top form,” Catra agreed, the reference to their normal bitter violence toward each other sending a shadow through Adora’s already tense expression. Catra leaned over her, unbuckling the belt around her waist and discarding it and that ridiculous red jacket Adora wore in record time. Her claws caught a little on the smooth spandex of Adora’s compression top as she pushed it and her sports bra up over her breasts and cupped both of them in her hands, earning a soft sigh from Adora’s lips as her eyes fluttered closed. She didn’t bother taking the shirt off, not wanting to separate from her lover long enough to get the tight piece of clothing over her big head. Tonight, Adora was so desperate and so needy that Catra wasn’t willing to make her wait even that long.

“Catra…” Adora whispered, her cheeks flushed now and her breathing a shade steadier than it had been when Catra first woke up. She relished the sound of her name on Adora’s lips and she watched her face as she touched her breasts, her fingertips finding her nipples and rolling them between them, her stomach

twisting with arousal at the sound that left the princess' lips, the way her spine arched up into her touch.

Adora was someone who was always in control. She rarely backed down and seemed to anyone else to be the perfect soldier, the perfect strategist and fighter, magnified tenfold by her superior strength and power when she transformed into that infuriating eight foot tall warrior. So it was fascinating to Catra that she only relaxed when she was completely at Catra's mercy, when she was stripped of that control completely and fell apart so easily under the feline's hands. It was nothing short of beautiful to see her break for her, to see the line between her brows soften and disappear and to hear her heartbeat slow and steady out and then speed up all over again as her arousal rose under Catra's searing touch. Adora's nipple between Catra's lips drew soft sounds from the blonde's mouth and she nipped gently at the pebbled flesh, flicking her tongue over it a little roughly several times and by now Adora's hips were twitching instinctively.

When Catra dragged Adora's pants and underwear down to her ankles she sighed softly and Catra admired her handiwork for a moment before climbing up to give her a kiss. Adora's clothes were still mostly on but all of them pushed out of place, exposing every part of her Catra needed to make her forget everything she'd come here burdened by. The sight of her so visibly wet for her made her heart hammer faster, and she could practically feel her pupils dilating. Adora was like this for her. Only for her. Adora's chest was rising and falling rapidly already and her cheeks and chest were flushed, though from embarrassment or arousal Catra couldn't tell, and she was looking up at her expectantly.

"Catra…" the princess whispered softly, a thousand unspoken questions on her lips and Catra covered them with her own hungrily, a hand on Adora's back pulling her torso up to bring her closer to her. As they kissed Catra couldn't help growling possessively low in her throat, a hand snaking down between Adora's legs and caressing her folds gently. Adora's lips faltered against her own, a soft sound breaking in her throat and Catra kissed her harder as she luxuriated in her wetness and spread it

lazily up along her clit as she started to circle it with her fingertip softly.

"You're so good," she promised Adora against her lips, giving her kiss after kiss, so drunk on the knowledge that it was *her* Adora came to on nights like this that she could barely think. Adora trembled under her touch. Catra caressed her, brought her to the edge of breathless insanity and when she drove one finger carefully inside of her, curling it against the place that drove her crazy Adora gasped her name and Catra forgot everything else. She opened her slowly, easing her onward with one finger before one became two and she pumped them inside of her in the exact rhythm that she knew would drive her over the edge, her thumb that was pressed firmly on her clit rubbing to match each thrust.

Whatever it was that haunted Adora tonight, whatever nameless meaningless thing that didn't matter when it was just the two of them together like this… it was long gone and there was only she and Catra, just the two of them on this overly firm bed in the sickly green light that was just bright enough to show off the soft shimmer of sweat along the lines of Adora's body. Catra could see the defined muscles of Adora's arms and stomach tensing and releasing and she knew she was so far gone that she wouldn't last long now. She kept up the pace diligently, watching Adora's face hungrily as she pushed her toward her peak. Adora's lips were parted slightly and her eyes were open halfway, gaze sliding in and out of focus as she looked back at Catra.

"You're doing good," Catra promised her, her words cresting into the first purr she'd let slip out since Adora defected. Adora's mouth curved into a smile as she registered the sound and one of her hands reached out, her fingertips ghosting over Catra's shoulder and the way she whispered her name…Catra couldn't help the intense jolt of arousal at that and her own wetness was becoming increasingly apparent. Adora's touch…*fuck*. The feeling of her touch, even just her fingertips caressing her arm helplessly as she started to rock her hips against Catra's hand…it was maddening. It was intoxicating. It made goosebumps break out under her fur and made it stand on end. "You're so good, Adora…"

her own voice sounded like it was underwater to her, and it shook with unspoken words and desperate arousal. "You're doing so good. You're so good. You can come for me, it's okay."

"Catra…" Adora gasped softly, her eyes falling closed as her cheeks flushed at the praise, and Catra pushed her higher and higher, as high as she could go, trying to ignore the soaked state of her own leggings, the heat and slick of Adora around her fingers just making it that much more unbearable.

When Adora let go, when her walls clenched around Catra's fingers and her eyes shot open, staring blankly skyward, Catra worked her through her orgasm patiently. Catra had never been one to be patient with life, always in a rush, always barreling headlong to the next thing with her life in the Horde, but with Adora…with Adora in bed… it was different. When it came to sex with Adora—and of course it was with Adora. Adora was the only one she ever wanted to give this side of her—she *wanted* to be patient. She didn't want this to end. She crooked her fingers insistently inside her with the sole intention of dragging it out, putting a little more pressure on her clit rather than less like she normally would to avoid overstimulation. She pushed Adora as far as she could go, and Adora rocked her hips against her hand, capturing her mouth with messy desperate kisses as she moaned low and hungry in her throat in a way that made Catra's arousal flame and fizzle enough that she had to hold back a whimper.

When Adora pulled back from their kiss, her breaths coming in short gasps, Catra tried to smile smugly at her but she was too out of control to. She expected Adora to pull her close and nestle to her chest until Catra told her to go, but instead she just looked at her a moment, her pupils blown wide, before she lunged back in for another kiss. It wasn't unusual for Adora to kiss her after sex, but it was never like *this*. The way she kissed her with a searing passion, the way she shifted their positions so she was cradling Catra to her. The way she removed Catra's mask and let it fall onto the bed, her fingers running through her hair with such a tenderness sparked with intensity…this was different. Catra's heart pounded.

"Catra…" Adora whispered against her lips, her free hand caressing the length of her back as she kissed the life out of her, kissed the air out of her lungs. She kissed her like she was her lifeline and like she was trying to destroy her all at once. "Do you want me?"

"What?" Catra was so surprised that her breath caught in her throat. Adora kissed her for a few more seconds before she said anything at all, her fingertips kneading into the muscles of Catra's back and soothing tension she didn't even know she had.

"Do you want me, Catra?" Adora's voice sent molten waves of need through her body and embarrassingly enough she actually shivered. Catra suddenly felt too hot and too cold all at once and her brain raced so quickly coherent thoughts slipped through her fingers. Catra just stared at her, sweaty blonde hair that had escaped from her ponytail stuck to her cheeks and temples and her shirt and bra still pushed up over her breasts, her leggings still down around her knees. The sight of her like that made it impossible to even think. How could she deny that she wanted her now, like this, when she kissed her again and moved the hand on her back to her hip, drawing tiny circles there as she kissed her like both their lives depended on it.

"It's okay, Catra…" Adora's voice was so soothing that Catra could feel knots in her shoulders untense. "It's okay if you don't. But I think you do. And I want you to know it's okay to admit it. Do you want me?"

Catra was surprised by this display of boldness after seeing Adora at the lowest she'd ever seen her just a short time before. In her most honest heart, it thrilled her. It was *hot*. The kisses Adora was trailing down her throat made her head feel like it was floating and every worry, every bit of polarizing fear that had kept her grounded every night that she had touched Adora felt like it singed away to bright sparks that faded into the dark and she found herself nodding desperately, pushing herself closer to the blonde as her shaking hands gripped strong shoulders, her claws catching on the spandex of Adora's shirt.

"I want you," she admitted in a gasp, and when Adora moved in for a kiss she returned it with everything she had.

"Can I take you?" Adora's harsh whisper made Catra's spine tingle and against all rationality, against all logic, she found herself nodding fervently, arching against Adora's touch as she ran her hand along her torso, over her chest, her palm rubbing her clothed breast and making her gasp.

"Yes…" she whispered, her voice tremoring as Adora pushed the top half of her bodysuit up, bunching it around her shoulders. "*Please*." One of Adora's hands moved to her lower back, holding some of her weight as the other cupped her breast. Catra pushed herself into her hand and when Adora started to tease her nipple, when she lowered her head to take it into her mouth and Catra felt the hot wetness of her tongue swirling it, she keened.

"Adora…" she gasped, unable to hold back anymore, doing everything she could not to squeeze her thighs together and chase an orgasm right then and there. How could she possibly explain that she was so turned on from getting Adora off that she was dangerously close to coming just from having her nipple sucked on? It was absolutely humiliating. Her heart hammered as she clutched at Adora tighter, the stimulation Adora was providing almost too much for her. "I'm…I need you to…"

Adora pulled her mouth from Catra's chest and looked into her eyes, and the look on her face was so exceptionally tender that Catra swore her heart stopped for a moment. "You're pretty worked up, huh? That's okay. Don't worry. I've got you, Catra. I've got you." The soothing tone and the words themselves were something Catra didn't even know she needed and she felt her body relax in Adora's arms as she gave her a gentle squeeze and then lay her tenderly down on the bed. "Don't worry. You can relax. I've got you now."

And Catra did. Catra believed her. She let Adora take the lead and she looked down to watch her as she pulled her underwear and leggings down and then off, discarding them carefully on the bed

beside her and she watched in disbelief as she arranged herself between her legs. Adora gave her a warm smile from her place between her thighs and she kissed the fur there a few times before lowering her mouth to her sex. More gentle kisses ghosted around it before Adora finally pressed her lips where she wanted them, opening her mouth and running her tongue along the entire length of her labia a few times with such a gentle insistence that Catra cried out. She was just as noisy as Adora but she couldn't bring herself to care. It didn't seem to matter now. Nothing else did. Adora's tongue found her clit and brushed it again and again as Catra felt her thighs start to shake. Adora hummed softly against her, her hand petting the fur on her outer thigh gently and encouragingly as she pushed her onward.

It was everything Catra had imagined all of those nights alone in her bed and more. The heat and enthusiasm of her mouth took her breath away and she couldn't help squeezing her thighs around Adora's head, clamping her in place unintentionally. She clenched and unclenched her hands, claws sheathing and unsheathing again and again as she fell apart, as she crumbled for Adora and she let go of everything and just let her have her. Adora took her with an intensity and a passion that Catra never could have replicated in her fantasies. She moved a hand to caress Catra's tail softly, comfortingly, her other running up and down her outer thigh with a sweetness that chased all of Catra's worries away.

"Adora…" Catra whimpered breathlessly, twisting helplessly on the sheets as she felt her release building, heat and sensitivity mounting in an all-encompassing wave that threatened to crush her. The sounds that tore from her lips were increasing in volume and frequency and the sweat beading on her forehead cooled her against the molten heat of her body that felt like it was on the verge of bursting into flames. The princess sucked her clit gently but firmly, her tongue enthusiastically fluttering over it inside her mouth, and Catra could only take so much of that before she absolutely broke. When she did, it was with a low moan that turned into helpless whispers of Adora's name as she fucked her face without even really meaning to. That insistent mouth kept

going as Catra shuddered through the waves of her orgasm and Adora didn't let up until Catra's body relaxed onto the bed.

When she sat up and looked at her, Adora's face shined with Catra's slick and she just stared down at the blonde in wonder before she closed her eyes, her breathing quick and rough, trying to convince herself that the whole thing happened, that it wasn't just a dream. When she opened her eyes Adora was still there, adjusting her shirt and pants, and she smiled at Catra warmly as she moved to fix Catra's clothes too.

"Thank you," Adora told her gently when they were settled in bed together, Catra so wrapped up in the smell of their lovemaking, of their joined and mingled scents, that she could barely muster any response but a nod. "You were wonderful. You did so good. I'm so proud of you."

This time, Catra didn't ask her to go. Adora held her to her chest and Catra knew that the other girl needed to go, but she couldn't bring herself to say so. This time, Catra fell asleep in her arms. This time, the sun was on the verge of coming up before Catra snuck down to the armory to steal Adora some armor to sneak out in, and this time, Catra got lost in kissing her until the morning wakeup alarm was about to ring.

This time, it didn't hurt as much to say goodbye.

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

> Well, here it is! The last chapter. It's very long and unbearably fluffy/cheesy because I couldn't help myself! It's so fluffy that it was almost embarrassing to edit lol. I hope you guys enjoy it and I want to thank everyone who's taken the time to read and comment/leave kudos! I appreciate it a lot and it makes me really happy to know people are enjoying my stories :)
>
> Also, I'm planning to start posting my full length SPOP fic in the next week or so! It isn't done yet but I have enough of it written that I won't be stressing about getting chapters done in time to post them. I'm just working on some editing and illustrations for it right now. If anybody is interested in reading it the first chapter should be up soon!

More often than not, when Catra woke up Adora was already gone. Today was no exception, and she stretched luxuriously in the bright warm light of the morning moons. The light filtering through the translucent curtain around she and Adora’s bed cast her fur in a soft purple light that reminded her of the same light that fell on Adora’s pale skin on the first morning they woke up in this bed together. Catra recalled with a smile opening her eyes to see a naked Adora watching her sleep on that first morning, the dopey grin on her face enough to get Catra on top of her in ten seconds flat to make the most of the quiet morning before someone came to rouse them.

The memory of that first intense night as a couple running into that beautiful equally intense first morning made Catra hum happily, pressing her legs together to deal with the arousal that spiked even at just the memory. Damn. If things were already hot and heavy between them when they were enemies, the fire that blazed between them as a couple made it look like nothing but a dim spark. She slid out of bed, stretching her body more

effectively with her feet on the floor, and wandered over to the windows near the waterfall. With a yawn she gazed out at Bright Moon as it gleamed in the warm light of the day's earliest moons.

"Hurry up, Adora…" she grumbled as she glanced at the clock on their shared dresser, placed charmingly beside a photo of the two of them the week after the defeat of Prime, arms wrapped around each other and some frosting from an end of the war celebratory cake smeared on Adora's nose. Three minutes to ten o' clock. This was usually around the time Adora would return from her morning run, which followed up her usual workout routine in the training room. Adora was nothing if not predictable, but despite knowing she likely didn't have long to wait, Catra's impatience flared up anyway. Thinking about their first night as a couple always put her in a mood, but somehow it seemed even more intense today than usual.

Now that she thought about it, it could have something to do with Adora explaining to her what the Etherian custom of 'marriage' was last night on their dinner date. Catra had been in a bit of a romantic frenzy ever since, the idea that that was something she and Adora could actually *do* getting under her skin in the best way possible. The thought of Adora being her wife instead of just her girlfriend…well. Despite the fact that they weren't seriously discussing the idea of marriage yet—being only six months into their relationship—Catra had a good feeling about it someday, in the future. A purr reliably picked up in her throat at just the thought. With her head full of thoughts of their future and Adora's smell all around the room, Catra couldn't help being both emotionally and physically excited. Adora was going to get the time of her *life* when she got back to the room.

Which…should have been a little while ago, according to the clock.

"What?" Catra stalked over to the offending piece of machinery, snatching it up as though it had the answer. "Where is she? Since when does Adora change up her routine?" Considering it took a good four months for the princess to wear anything besides her Horde uniform after the war, Catra figured she had reason to be

concerned and that she wasn't just being an overly clingy girlfriend.

Okay, maybe it was a bit of both.

The sound of the door handle engaging prompted Catra to drop the clock back into its place, and she turned and stood facing the doorway, hand on her hip. The picture of absolute nonchalance. These days Catra saw little reason to put her pajamas back on after the festivities she and Adora typically participated in at least once nightly, and hopefully getting an eyeful of her naked as soon as she came into the room would be enough to coax her girlfriend back into bed, Catra hoped.

"Hey, Adora," she purred the second she saw the other girl slip into the room clad in her usual workout attire, and she sauntered in her direction as Adora closed the door behind her.

"Hey yourself," the blonde offered cheekily, though her voice sounded just the faintest bit tired. "Didn't get dressed this morning?"

"Why should I?" Catra asked her with one eyebrow raised, running a hand along Adora's arm. "I'd just take them off anyway."

"Yeah?" Catra definitely picked up on the interest in Adora's tone. As Adora kicked off her socks and shoes, Catra moved in even closer, her chest brushing the taller girl's.

"Yeah…" purring enthusiastically, Catra looped her arms around Adora's neck, and with a small hum Adora pushed her head forward to rest her forehead against Catra's.

"You're late today. I was in here *pining* for you." The heartbreak in her voice was purposely exaggerated. "What happened?"

"Oh, uh…" Adora's tone instantly turned sheepish. "I had a little bit of a…moment."

"Moment?" instantly, Catra sprung into protective mode. "Are you okay? Why didn't you come and find me?"

Adora pulled back to smile at her, her expression gentle. "You were sleeping, Catra. I didn't want to wake you up. Besides, pushing that kind of thing off on you all the time isn't good. I need to learn to deal with this on my own. Perfuma says it's good to use healthy coping mechanisms."

"So fucking your problems away isn't considered one of them?"

Adora laughed, and the snort in it made Catra's heart melt in an instant. God, was she smitten with this girl. "Apparently not. According to Perfuma if I don't deal with this stuff on my own instead of just relying on you to make it better then I won't ever be able to learn to manage it myself and get better, so I tried to do some of the things she's taught me."

"Good job, Adora," Catra told her warmly, and the way Adora's eyes lit up when she said it made Catra's breath catch in her throat. Praise was still something that Adora craved more than anything, and being able to give it to her made Catra feel like she was finally doing something worthwhile with her life. "How did it go?"

"Okay, I think…" Adora let out a long breath. "I did some of the breathing exercises Perfuma showed me, and it helped. Then I took my run to calm down the rest of the way. I think I'm really starting to get the hang of actually…dealing with this stuff. Apparently according to Spinerella there's actual *medicine* you can take to help with…"anxiety"…too. Maybe I should look into that? I guess breathing techniques can only do so much, right?"

"That's a good idea. You should ask the palace doctors about it. You're doing great, babe. I'm proud of you." The sincerity in Catra's voice was apparent even to her own ears, and so the way Adora's eyes shined briefly with tears before she blinked them away and cleared her throat wasn't a surprise, but it did remind Catra all over again of how now, she finally had the ability to do

good things for Adora. Offer her more than just the physical when it came to enriching her life. These days her day to day life consisted of essentially making Adora happy in absolutely any way possible, and it felt ten times more rewarding than anything she had ever accomplished with the Horde. With Adora focusing on doting on Catra as well, the two of them spent most of their days on cloud nine. Of course there were hard days and it wasn't as though they never fought. But the domestic bliss Catra found herself in the absolute majority of the time was enough that it was easy to forget they'd ever been enemies at all.

"Thanks, Catra…" Adora went in for a kiss, and Catra returned it with enough passion that Adora absolutely undeniably swooned, much to Catra's smugness. Taking on enough of her girlfriend's weight that she could just relax in her arms, Catra nipped playfully at her bottom lip. Adora's arms around her waist tightened just a bit, a tiny moan rising in her throat.

"How are you feeling now?" she purred softly, her claws kneading affirmingly at the small of Adora's back, a silent unspoken promise of love, and Adora surrendered to her touch, putting more weight on Catra. Pleased, Catra shifted a bit to hold her up better, pushing Adora's back against the nearby door so she could focus on kissing a slow little trail of tiny pecks along the shell of the ear of the most beautiful girl on Etheria. "Do you need anything?"

"I feel great…" Adora muttered dreamily, absolutely blissed out of her mind. An involuntary chuckle broke up in Catra's throat, one of absolute fondness that bubbled over into a happy hum. "Super great. Forgot why I was even having a hard morning…"

"You're slurring," Catra giggled, pushing her body into her girlfriend's, their curves melting together as perfectly as their lips in the gentle but passionate kiss Adora gave her when her mouth was at close enough range. Every kiss they'd shared since the one beside the Heart at the end of the world was better than the last, and Catra's purr blazed up to a deafening roar in the face of the warmth and love Adora conveyed with each press of her lips. The taste of her mouth when she parted her lips a bit sent a quick

flash of heat between Catra's legs, reminding her all over again of the state she'd woken up in.

"Maybe…" Adora whispered breathlessly into the tiny gap she frustratingly made between their lips. "Love you."

"I love you too, idiot," Catra moved in for a hungrier kiss, absolutely stunned by the speed at which Adora reciprocated her passion, her fingers pressing errantly at her lower back, twisting the fur there between her fingertips. Oh, so luckily Catra wasn't the only one who was in a mood this morning. Her lips twisting upward into a sly smile, she broke the kiss and tipped Adora's head back with one hand to gain access to her throat. Adora melted into the bites and kisses Catra lavished onto the side of her neck, pressing herself closer even as she huffed.

"Catra…" Adora warned breathlessly, squirming a little. "You're gonna leave marks."

"You can heal them, right?" Catra purred, leaving a particularly hard nip that made Adora moan especially deliciously. "Or wear a turtleneck. What's the big deal?"

"I can't believe you're making me use She-ra for something like this…" Adora grumbled, though the helpless whimper that left her mouth next after another rough nip cut off her attempt at sounding annoyed.

"You know you love healing my love bites…" Catra reminded her in her most seductive voice. "Leave them until the meeting later, okay? I like looking at you with them."

"'kay…" Adora was beyond arguing at this point, absolutely receptive to the hickey that Catra gave her between tender kisses to her throat just because she knew she could get away with it. Adora was absolutely putty in her hands. Already she could smell her arousal picking up.

One hand pushing up under the loose workout top Adora was wearing, Catra snapped her sports bra and made her gasp in

shock. “You have *got* to stop wearing a bra, babe. It makes it so much harder to get to the good stuff…” the seductive drawl in her voice seemed to be getting to Adora enough that she wasn’t able to respond immediately.

“When I’m working out? My boobs would be flopping all over the place, Catra.”

“I wouldn’t mind seeing that,” Catra mused with a sharp nip right under her jaw before she wiggled her hand under the elastic of the bra and cupped her breast. The soft sigh that escaped Adora’s lips made her smile. “Good?”

“Yeah…” the blissed out dopey tone in Adora’s voice sent a flare of blindingly intense love and tenderness through Catra’s heart.

“You really need to be touched today, don’t you?” she asked softly, and Adora nodded fervently, nuzzling her cheek against Catra’s hair. As her fingers toyed with her breast gently, Catra shifted Adora enough that her back was fully braced against the door. With the door supporting her girlfriend Catra was free to move her other hand to one side, caressing up and down her soft skin and marveling quietly at the firm muscles just underneath. She touched her with a care and tenderness that she hadn’t known she possessed back when she would fuck Adora senseless when she came to her broken. Now, there was a sense of softness here that Catra reveled in, trust and warmth that filled her body from the top of her head to the tip of her toes as she caressed Adora softly just for the sake of touching her, of telling her wordlessly with her touch how much she adored her and how much she wanted to stay by her side for the rest of time and beyond, if that was at all possible.

Catra liked the little gasp that escaped Adora’s lips when she started to toy with her nipple. “You’re so warm…” she told the blonde appreciatively, whose soft hum was followed up by an insistent push of fingertips into the fur of Catra’s back.

“Kiss me…” the demand was soft, but desperate, and Catra complied gladly, the hand on Adora’s side pushing her shorts down a little to caress along the curve of her hip as she did. The warmth of Adora’s mouth never got any less delicious.

“Of course, princess,” Catra purred between kisses, her lips wet from how sloppy they were getting. “Anything for you.”

“Mmm…” Adora’s hands moved up to run through Catra’s hair, which was unfortunately at an awkward length after six months of growth. ‘I like it’ Adora insisted over and over again whenever Catra complained about it these days, despite Catra’s insistence that it looked stupid.

Grateful for every moment they spent like this together, Catra kissed her with all of the love and passion and lust that rolled in waves through her whenever she held Adora like this. Adora’s heart was hammering; Catra’s sensitive ears could pick it up easily. The thrumming of her blood was always exciting to Catra, and that coupled with the heady scent of her girlfriend’s arousal pushed Catra’s patience to the limit.

“I wanna taste you,” she growled, pulling away to push the top and bra up and out of the way. Adora struggled out of them and tossed them onto the floor while Catra lowered her head to lave her tongue over Adora’s nipple. Her own heart was starting to pound loudly in her ears.

“I haven’t showered yet,” Adora protested, though she sounded delighted. “Catra, I’m gross!”

“You’re never gross…” sucking on Adora’s nipple shut the princess up, and in no time she was panting softly above her, the taught muscles of her abs fluttering under Catra’s hand as she caressed up and down her stomach. The taste of Adora’s sweat from her workout was intoxicating to Catra, pulling at her instincts in a truly primal way and just making her want to take her even more. In the years before when Catra made love to Adora, she held some parts of herself back, afraid of the instincts to take, to dominate

completely, almost to *destroy*. Those impulses didn't scare her now; she loved and desired Adora so strongly and completely that it awakened deeper more primal parts of her that she didn't know existed, but it didn't mean anything bad. It was just how deeply she felt driven to couple with Adora. Now, more than ever, Catra was sure that she was her soulmate.

"Can I have you?" she asked softly, extricating her mouth from her breast long enough to speak, and Adora made a tiny 'mmm' sound, looking down at her just in time for Catra to look up and meet her eyes. She made sure to lick her lips suggestively, implying her intentions, and despite the innumerable nights they'd spent in the throes of passion together, Adora flushed.

"I just got back from my workout…" she protested weakly, though the brief flash of glowing bright blue in Adora's eyes—magic, a hint of She-ra she couldn't hold back when she was overly turned on—gave away her true feelings. "I'm sweaty and gross and…"

"I don't care," Catra told her pointedly, dropping to her knees. "I like your taste no matter what. If that's your only reason for holding back… If you *want* this. I wanna know. Tell me."

"I want this," Adora breathed, eyes snapping shut as she leaned her head back against the door. Catra didn't waste any time tugging down her shorts and underwear, letting them pool around her ankles as she licked her lips at the sight of her prize.

"Damn, you must really like me." Catra's tone was cheeky. "You wouldn't even believe how wet you are."

"Yeah?" Adora's shaky voice spoke just as much to her arousal as the wetness that was prominently on display, smeared over her folds and even onto her outer lips.

"Yeah. You look *good*." A purr rose louder in Catra's throat as she took her first taste, licking away some of the visible wetness. Adora's hips bucked slightly under the invasion of her tongue. "Spread your legs a little more for me?"

The way Adora complied immediately was delicious and it was difficult to ignore her own arousal as she spread Adora open gently with one hand, the other braced on Adora's thigh. Tail moving to curl around her calf, Catra just stared for a moment. She knew it embarrassed Adora, but she just the loved to take in the sight of Adora wet for her, flushed with arousal. Staring like this could never get old. She imagined half a century later she'd still be gazing at Adora like this every night, her breath so taken away by the very concept that she was allowed to make love to this woman at all that she could barely even function.

Despite her earlier impatience, Catra was content to take her time now that she was faced with the sight of Adora like this. She licked her slowly, lovingly, ignoring Adora's whimpers of protest at being teased so much like this. Maybe it was cruel, but Catra loved teasing her, loved getting her to the brink of madness with desire for her. It reminded her all over again that she was the one Adora wanted, against all odds. Pointedly avoiding stimulating her too much, Catra explored the blonde leisurely with her tongue. Contrary to Adora's insistence that she was gross, Catra loved the taste of her sweat, the muskiness of her natural taste that was so unique to Adora that the intimacy of it made her head swim.

"Should I take you to bed?" she asked Adora softly, looking up to see the nod that her girlfriend gave her wordlessly and at the confirmation she stood, wrapping her arms around her waist and lifting her just a few inches. Adora's workout shorts and underwear were left behind on the floor as she gently carried her princess to bed. It had gotten easier to pick her up in the last few months, but she had more than a little practice. She usually insisted on carrying Adora to bed before making love to her, and despite Adora's protests and embarrassment, she knew she loved it. As she lowered her lover gently into the softness of their bed, she pressed a few kisses to her cheeks and forehead before venturing lower. "I love you."

"I love you too," Adora replied reverently, her voice breathless. Catra kissed down her chest and stomach, nuzzling and scent marking her thighs between kisses before she dived back in

without warning. Adora gasped softly as Catra spread her open gently once more, tail looping lovingly around her leg and free hand kneading her thigh with a tenderness and love that she was lucky for another way to release; simply saying the words would never be enough. Words could never do this thing between them justice.

"You are so beautiful," Catra told her softly before going straight for her clit this time. Adora moaned softly as her tongue caressed it gently a few times. Catra was purring harder than ever. Adora would have her hands at her sides, Catra thought, able to discern exactly what her actions would be even with her eyes closed. Her hands would be at her sides, palms up in a vulnerable gesture that indicated a trust she could never even begin to verbalize, and then she would start gripping helplessly at the sheets when she moved to take her clit into her mouth, tongue still brushing it insistently as she started to suck. Yes, she knew Adora well. The sound of her short blunt fingernails against silk confirmed her assumptions. Adora was falling apart so quickly for her today.

"Catra…" she whispered softly, her voice labored with pleasure, and Catra drowned in it, knowing how good she was making her feel, humbled that she was able to. The hand on Adora's thigh slowly slid below Catra's chin, claws sheathing carefully and completely to press gently at her entrance. She was always surprised by how wet she could get her, but today seemed to be a special occasion, because she found her practically dripping. Adora let out a loud breath when she pressed two fingers inside. After so many nights together before and after the war, Catra knew Adora's body better than she knew her own, and her fingertips found her g-spot with little effort, focusing there as she started to curl her fingers slowly inside of her. One of Adora's thighs was starting to shake violently, and Catra purred even harder with the knowledge that she was crumbling for her already.

'Perfect', she thought as she sucked a little more insistently at her clit, coaxing her toward her impending orgasm with a gentle patience that she reserved for Adora and Adora alone. Everything about her was perfect to Catra, and with no expectations. Adora

had always felt so driven to be perfect, to be *good*, and Catra hoped against all hope that she truly understood that that she always would be in her eyes. With her mouth occupied, she couldn't offer the words and promises of goodness that Adora had once run on, been spurred by, been unable to function without, but this morning in their bed with the brightening morning moonlight falling over them, so far away from the Horde and the Fright Zone, it didn't matter and Catra knew it. Their scars—both physical and emotional—from the war and their complicated history and all of the battles between them were slowly fading to nothing and the two of them were here with nothing holding them back. Here together with no need for anything else.

"Catra…you're so amazing…" Adora whispered, and she sounded so starstruck that Catra nearly burst from love. "This feels so good…you feel so good…"

When Adora got talkative, it usually meant she was close. Catra moved her fingers a little more insistently, thrusting harder and making sure to make almost brutal contact with the spot that never failed to make Adora fall over the edge. By now Catra knew her limits, knew exactly what Adora could take, and the roughness with which she curled her fingers inside her was exactly what she needed. It always was. Adora's moans and whimpers raising in urgency kept her going past the point when her wrist started to hurt. A few more brushes of her tongue against Adora's clit was all it took for her to crumble, for her to cry out Catra's name as her muscles all went tense at once. The sounds that escaped from her mouth were absolutely filthy and desperate and beautiful all at once, and Catra heard a soft ripping sound from somewhere above her. The sheets again. It never ceased to surprise her that Adora was the one who tended to destroy their bedlinens despite the fact that Catra was the one sporting a set of razor sharp claws.

Adora quaked around Catra, the strong muscles of her legs pressing at her sides. Her walls fluttered around Catras fingers, her breaths came in sharp gasps in between her wanton moans and sobs of Catra's name, and Catra opened her eyes to look up

at her girlfriend, to watch the expression on her face as she came for her. The sight of her face and the sounds she was making were almost unbearably arousing and Catra kept up her two points of contact diligently as Adora's orgasm crashed through her, working her through it as lovingly as she knew how. When Adora's muscles all went limp at once and her back lowered back onto the bed with a soft flop, Catra drew her mouth back from her, licking Adora's essence from her lips before wiping her chin on the back of her hand. She kept her fingers inside her for a few quiet moments while Adora caught her breath, and then she withdrew them slowly and sucked them clean, making sure to make eye contact with her girlfriend when she did.

"Wow…" Adora whispered softly, her voice sounding absolutely drunk. She was so caught up in her afterglow that it seemed to take her a great effort to sit, and when she did she was trembling. Catra knew the feeling well, and she was absolutely content in her smugness at the fact that she'd absolutely blown Adora's mind.

"Good?" Catra asked smugly, and Adora's wordless nod spoke volumes. "Thanks for letting me, babe. I really needed to taste you today."

"I wanna taste you too," Adora replied breathlessly, excitedly, her cheeks flushing despite how many times she'd gone down on her by now. In the weeks after the end of the war in particular Adora spent so much time with her head between her legs that Catra had joked about getting her a change of address form.

"You sure you're in the state for that?" Catra cupped her cheek gently. "You seem like you're having trouble getting your body to work."

"It works, it works," Adora grumbled, reaching out. "C'mere, lay down. I'll take good care of you, Catra."

Catra didn't doubt it for a second, but she had a better idea. "How about *you* lay down?" she purred.

“Me? But you just—”

“No, I mean…” wiggling her eyebrows, she leaned in to ghost her lips over Adora’s, prompting a fullbody shiver from the blonde. “Lay down so I can sit on your face.”

“Oh. Oh!” Adora’s eyes glittered at that, her cheeks going even pinker. “Okay. But first, foreplay. I’m not gonna do this halfway, okay?”

“You never do,” Catra agreed with a nod, knowing that Adora would never pass up on the opportunity to make her into a desperate mess. As usual, her girlfriend didn’t disappoint, the deep and passionate kisses that she pulled her into almost immediately paired deliciously with her hands cupping Catra’s breasts, exploring them and caressing them slowly. The gentle patience with which her hands toyed with her breasts was a direct contrast to the desperate and hungry way she kissed her, and Catra delighted in the knowledge that Adora could probably taste herself on Catra’s tongue. It turned her on even more, and the slight jolt of pain when Adora pinched one of her nipples a little harder than Catra would have dared to do herself just furthered the already molten heat between her legs.

True, it had taken Catra years to allow Adora to reciprocate in bed, but as soon as that first night not long before they no longer found themselves on opposite sides of the war, Adora hadn’t wasted any time mapping out her body with a diligence that made Catra wonder if she’d actually made notes and charts and diagrams like she did for military strategy. By now, her intimate knowledge of all the ways she could make Catra crazy was so extensive that sometimes Catra felt like she was losing the upper hand—though with Adora, losing the upper hand could be delicious. For instance, Catra never would have assumed she would enjoy pain, but Adora knew better. The tiniest bit of it, like a quick nipple pinch coupled with a gentle caress to her other nipple while Adora kissed her messily, sent shockwaves through her body and made her neediness even closer to being absolutely unbearable.

Every little reaction, every thing that worked and even the ones that didn't, Adora seemed to have memorized. The lines she traced on Catra's skin were measured, controlled, passionate but designed specifically to push her over the edge, and Catra found herself so aroused that she was shivering. Adora lowering her head to suck on her nipples one at a time with an almost rough attentiveness didn't help, either. By this point her arousal was starting to become almost painful. If Catra didn't know any better she'd assume the inherent abilities that came along with being She-ra included mindreading, because it was at that moment that Adora chose to snake one hand between her legs, spreading her palm over Catra's sex and starting to rub in gentle motions with it, just enough stimulation to keep her from going crazy.

"Adora please…" Catra whispered, humiliated that she was resorting to begging. Adora let go of her nipple with a soft pop, moving her lips back up to hers for a searing kiss that made Catra's heartbeat skip. "You're driving me crazy."

"That's the plan…" the cockiness in Adora's tone made her want to slap her, but instead she just leaned a little harder back on her hands, pressing her forehead to her girlfriend's.

"Haven't you shown off enough?" the planned annoyance in Catra's words was foiled by the obvious lust that clouded her voice. "Come *on*. Can't you just get me off already?"

"I live to please," Adora replied in an almost singsong voice, flopping hard back onto the bed on her back with enough force to make the entire piece of furniture shake. Adora had already ruined the sheets. Did she really need to ruin the whole bed, too? "Come here, Catra. Let me make you feel good."

"You'd better…" Catra growled, though her heart wasn't in the feigned malice. As she crawled up over Adora's body to get to her face, Adora pressed soft and gentle kisses to every bit of her she could reach, though she was forced to flatten her torso to the bed when Catra straddled her shoulders. Then, Adora settled for

taking one of Catra's hands, kissing each finger up and down and then pressing tender, loving kisses to her palm.

"I love you so much," she whispered, and the sincere emotion in it took Catra's breath away. "You're so perfect, Catra. I'm the luckiest person in the whole universe."

"Look who's talking…" Catra replied, trying to sound cheeky, but her voice was heavy with emotion too. "You're everything anybody could ever want. I still don't understand what you'd want with somebody like me." She was only half serious, but Adora's brow knitted in concern anyway.

"You're *amazing*, Catra," she told her very, very sincerely, her fingers lacing through Catra's as her free hand gripped Catra's thigh, kneading it gently in exactly the way Catra tended to do, though Adora didn't have claws to complete the effect. It still felt perfect. "You're sweet and smart and funny and beautiful and you're everything I could ever want for the rest of my life. I love you more than anything!"

"You too…" Catra couldn't believe she was getting choked up right now. It was less embarrassing to focus on how ungodly horny she was. "You're…Adora, if I keep talking I'm gonna get all mushy." She didn't want to say 'I'm gonna cry', but something in Adora's eyes told her that she didn't have to. The soft look she was giving her spoke words she didn't even need to say.

"I love you, Catra…" she whispered, putting one hand on the small of her back to guide her forward a bit, and Catra braced herself against the blonde's strong shoulders, her thighs relying on her lover's impressive strength to be able to support her. Sure, their upbringing had given the two of them more than their fair share of trauma, but dating a former solider had *some* advantages.

"I love you too…" Catra's words transitioned sharply into a gasp when Adora licked a long stripe between her legs, her tongue caressing her with the same gentle insistence that her words had soothed her. She was already so turned on that she bucked

against Adora's tongue, and Adora chuckled low in her throat and kept it up. The way her tongue brushed against Catra's clit so firmly after only a few seconds of searching made Catra's fluttering eyes snap open, something half between a moan and a primal growl escaping her throat.

"Dammit, Adora…" Catra wasn't angry despite the words; she just tended to swear quite a bit when she was this worked up. "How are you so good at this?" Adora was someone who seemed at first glance that she would be bashful and uncertain of herself in bed. Catra had fantasized so many times about how it would be when she got her off in the years when their sexual relationship was onesided, and she had been absolutely enthralled by fantasy Adora when she was awkward and cautious about touching her. But it turned out that instead Adora was passionate and confident and rivaled even Catra in her desire for and prowess at being in control.

As she always did early on, Adora focused on slow and purposeful licks with the flat of her tongue, and Catra braced her hands on Adora's chest, trying not to crush her breasts in the process as she drowned in the sensations she was giving her. Being this turned on made her sensitive in a way she hadn't been in a while and every brush of Adora's tongue felt like it was making stars spark up inside her body. As her thighs started to shake, Catra couldn't help it anymore, and she began to slowly thrust into Adora's face, meeting the pushes of her tongue and increasing the sensation even more.

"Can you breathe?" Catra asked, and Adora laughed softly against her, shaking her head.

Quickly, Catra adjusted herself a little, putting more weight on her knees and hands, enough that she was holding herself up mostly, just resting lightly on Adora's face as she began to run her clit along the princess' tongue. With a soft 'mmm' Adora reached up to rub the spot she'd discovered a few months ago just above Catra's tail, and she shouldn't help the fullbody shiver at the sensation as it coupled with the smooth warmth of Adora's tongue

against her clit made her see stars. It was all too much and not enough at once and Catra was only dimly aware of the sounds that were leaving her mouth completely independent of her free will.

"Adora…" she gasped, her claws starting to knead involuntarily into Adora's chest. As much as she wanted to keep it gentle, she could barely even control herself. Every sensation felt magnified by the sensitivity her impending orgasm was causing and it was enough that her mind was absolutely blank and she was so wrapped up in Adora, only Adora, that if the world ended right now she doubted she would even notice. The needy moans and gasps that left her mouth sounded like they belonged to someone else, like they were coming from far away. "Adora…Adora…" she gasped her name over and over without even meaning to.

It was starting to feel almost unbearably hot in the room. Catra wound her tail around Adora's wrist where her hand still rubbed that spot above her tail while Adora's other hand reached up to toy gentle with one of her nipples, her mouth shifting to take her clit inside it. Catra keened, still grinding her hips to control the stimulation as Adora flattened her tongue out against her clit, applying gentle suction. Catra could feel herself tipping over the edge, and she rolled her hips jerkily into Adora's mouth as she came apart at the seams. The blinding heat and intensity of her pleasure channeled into one concentrated wave of white hot sensation that rolled through her clit, magnified and centered by the insistent pressure of Adora's mouth providing stimulation exactly where she needed it. Catra bucked unsteadily into Adora's mouth, her hands clutching desperately at her where they were planted, her thighs shaking and clenching and unclenching.

It seemed to go on forever. Adora patiently and enthusiastically coaxed Catra through the blinding intensity of her climax and then slower, gentler into the aftershocks that sparkled through her like ripples after a massive splash. It was clear Adora was intent on drawing every last bit of pleasure out of her that she could, and Catra's jerking thighs could barely hold her up through the last seconds of fleeting stimulation before it started to transition into

oversensitivity. When she relaxed back onto Adora's chest, the woman beneath her gulped in a huge breath and then started to pant, laughing a rough but fond laugh as she looked up at Catra in such an adoring way that Catra wouldn't have been surprised if she had hearts for pupils.

"Wow…" Adora gasped, her breathing sounding like she'd run a marathon. "You were amazing, Catra."

"Sorry if I suffocating you a little." Sheepishly, Catra smiled down at her.

"Don't be sorry. That was incredible. You were so into it. I came *again* you were so hot."

"Without me even touching you?" Catra was nothing short of enthralled by that information, and she shifted to lay on Adora's chest, purring softly at the way her girlfriend's arms came up to encircle her so quickly it seemed to be on instinct. "Wow."

"Now it's your turn to be cocky," Adora told her with a grin. Her chin and nose glistened with Catra's wetness. "You were incredible."

"*You* were incredible," Catra countered, nestling her head under Adora's chin and letting Adora shift a bit to get comfortable before she spoke again. "You're always incredible. You're wonderful, Adora. You're good. You're so good. Even if you feel like you're not good sometimes, you're always good enough for me. And you don't *have* to be good. You don't deserve love and happiness any less if you aren't good. You don't have to prove yourself or give everything up or save everyone anymore. You don't have to earn anything. All you have to be is Adora, okay?"

"Catra…" the tremble in Adora's voice made it obvious she was holding back tears, and Catra closed her eyes, her fingertips playing gently at Adora's skin as the two of them breathed slower, their bodies relaxing from their exertion for their heartbeats and

breaths to slowly harmonize. “Thank you. I…don’t even know what to say.”

“You don’t have to say anything, dummy…” Catra assured her, kissing her collarbone and shifting to rise up enough to look her in the eye. When she cupped Adora’s cheek, the blonde’s hand came up to cover hers and for a long time they just stared into each other’s eyes, tears rolling down Adora’s cheeks silently. Catra made a point of not commenting on them. After a while Adora startled her by rolling over, dragging Catra with her onto their sides so they could lay with their foreheads together.

“I love you so much…” the princess whispered reverently, like she was praying, and Catra’s purrs intensified.

“I love you too.” Before too long, it would be lunchtime. They had definitely already missed breakfast. Later, Bow and Glimmer would come to see why they hadn’t made it out of the room yet. Later, they would have to deal with the rest of the world. But for now, with her arms wrapped around her girlfriend and with Adora returning the embrace with just as much tenderness and love, Catra wasn’t worried about any of that. Right now, the rest of the world ceased to exist. There was only Adora. Adora with her chest rising and falling softly as Catra played with her hair. Adora with notable scratches on her chest from their lovemaking, with bites on her neck that Catra had left to mark her as only hers, Adora whose eyes watched her with such genuine tenderness and love that Catra could barely breathe.

For now, the rest of the world could wait. For now, Adora—the girl who proclaimed herself that she had never relaxed ever in her life—had fallen back asleep in Catra’s arms despite the fact that it was fast approaching noon. Catra settled in a little closer to her, arms curled protectively around her as she reveled in her scent, starting to feel a little sleepy herself.

Just as she had every day for the past six months, Catra dozed off right where she belonged.

End Notes

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